10–11 SEPTEMBER 2026 · NUFFIELD COLLEGE, OXFORD

The Atkinson Conference

on Economic and Social Inequality

About the Conference

The Atkinson Conference on Economic and Social Inequality brings together leading researchers from economics, sociology, social policy, and related disciplines for two days of interdisciplinary exchange at Nuffield College, Oxford. The conference is jointly coordinated by the **Department of Social Policy & Intervention (DSPI)**, the **Institute for New Economic Thinking at the Oxford Martin School (INET Oxford)**, and **Nuffield College**.

The conference is named in honour of **Sir Anthony (Tony) Atkinson** (1944–2017), one of the most influential scholars of inequality of the twentieth century. A Fellow of Nuffield College for over two decades and Warden of the College from 1994 to 2005, Atkinson pioneered the measurement of income inequality and poverty, and championed the use of rigorous evidence to inform policy. His work continues to shape how we understand and address inequality around the world.

The conference is organised with the blessing of the Atkinson family.

We welcome both established and early-career scholars working on questions of economic and social inequality, broadly defined. There are no registration fees.

AT A GLANCE

DATES

10–11 September 2026

VENUE

Nuffield College, Oxford

FORMAT

Keynotes, parallel sessions, panel discussion, conference dinner

PARTICIPANTS

Up to 98

REGISTRATION FEE

None

Speakers & Plenary Events

KEYNOTE LECTURE

Janet Gornick

City University of New York (CUNY)

"High and Rising Economic Inequalities in Affluent Countries: Nature, Causes, and Consequences"

CLOSING KEYNOTE

Philippe Aghion

Collège de France & London School of Economics · 2025 Nobel Laureate in Economic Sciences

"Creative destructions and the quest for inclusive growth"

OPENING PANEL

Inequality in the Age of AI

Moderated by Sarah O'Connor, Financial Times

A moderated discussion to open the conference

Additional speakers and panellists to be announced.

Call for Papers

We invite contributions on all aspects of economic and social inequality — empirical, theoretical, and methodological. There are two ways to participate: a standard presentation of your research, or a short 'Room for Debate' pitch on one of our two prompts.

How to Participate

Please choose one of the two tracks below. All submissions are due by **22 May 2026**; decisions will be communicated by **8 June 2026**.

TRACK 1

Standard Presentation

Submit either a short abstract (**up to 500 words**) or an extended abstract (**up to 4 pages**) describing the research question, data and methods, and main findings or expected contributions.

Submit via Google Form →

TRACK 2

'Room for Debate' Presentation

A 5-minute pitch on one of our two Room for Debate prompts:

- [Prompt 1 TBC]
- [Prompt 2 TBC]

Pitches may draw on your own research or on existing literature. The aim is to take a clear stance on the prompt, make the case for it, and engage in friendly exchange with presenters who may take an opposing view — a productive airing of competing perspectives to advance the study of inequality.

Submit via Google Form →

Topics of Interest

We welcome papers on topics including, but not limited to:

Income & Wealth Inequality
Measurement, trends, drivers

Poverty & Social Exclusion
Dynamics, policies, cross-national comparisons

Labour Markets
Wages, precarity, automation, gig economy

Redistribution & the Welfare State
Tax-transfer policy, social investment

Social Policy Analysis
Welfare states, tax and transfer systems, policy evaluation

Health & Education Inequalities
Social determinants, intergenerational mobility

Inequality & Technology
AI, digitalisation, platform economies

Global & Comparative Perspectives
Developing countries, cross-national analysis

Race, Gender & Intersectionality
Structural inequalities, discrimination

Programme Overview

The detailed programme with session topics and paper assignments will be published after abstract decisions. Below is the planned schedule structure.

Thursday, 10 September 2026

08:30–09:00	REGISTRATION	**Registration & coffee**
09:00–10:00	OPENING SESSION	**Introductory Remarks & Panel on Inequality in the Age of AI** Moderated by Sarah O'Connor (Financial Times)
10:00–10:30	BREAK	**Coffee**
10:30–12:00	PARALLEL SESSIONS	**Paper presentations** 3 parallel rooms
12:00–13:00	LUNCH	**Buffet lunch**
13:00–14:30	PARALLEL SESSIONS	**Paper presentations** 3 parallel rooms
14:30–15:00	BREAK	**Coffee**
15:00–16:30	PARALLEL SESSIONS	**Paper presentations** 3 parallel rooms
16:45–17:45	ROOM FOR DEBATE	**Debate-style sessions** 3 parallel rooms
18:00–19:00	SOCIAL	**Drinks reception**
19:00	DINNER	**Conference dinner** Nuffield College Dining Hall

Friday, 11 September 2026

08:30–09:00	COFFEE	**Morning coffee & pastries**
09:00–10:30	PARALLEL SESSIONS	**Paper presentations** 3 parallel rooms
10:30–11:00	BREAK	**Coffee**

11:00–12:15	KEYNOTE **Janet Gornick**
12:15–13:15	LUNCH **Buffet lunch**
13:15–14:45	PARALLEL SESSIONS **Paper presentations** 3 parallel rooms
14:45–15:30	BREAK **Coffee**
15:30–16:30	CLOSING KEYNOTE **Philippe Aghion** “Creative destructions and the quest for inclusive growth”
17:00	OPTIONAL **Informal dinner in Oxford**

Key Dates

DATE	MILESTONE
22 May 2026	Abstract submission deadline
8 June 2026	Notification of acceptance
10–11 Sept 2026	Conference at Nuffield College, Oxford

Venue & Travel

Nuffield College

New Road, Oxford OX1 1NF, United Kingdom

Nuffield College is located in the heart of Oxford, a short walk from the train station and city centre. All conference sessions, meals, and social events take place on the college grounds.

Getting to Oxford

- **By train:** Oxford station is a 5-minute walk from Nuffield College. Direct trains from London Paddington (~1 hr) and other major cities.
- **By bus:** The Oxford Tube and X90 run frequently from London Victoria (~1.5 hrs).
- **By air:** London Heathrow (LHR) is the nearest major airport, with direct bus connections to Oxford (~1.5 hrs). Birmingham (BHX) is also convenient.

Accommodation

Oxford offers a wide range of accommodation options. We recommend booking early, as September is a busy period.

- Details on recommended hotels and any group booking arrangements will be posted here closer to the conference.

Conference Dinner

A conference dinner will be held on Thursday evening in the Nuffield College Dining Hall. All registered participants are welcome.

Organising Committee & Contact

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For questions about the conference, submissions, or logistics, please contact the organising committee:

[contact email TBC]

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Nuffield College · Department of Social Policy & Intervention · Institute for New Economic Thinking at the Oxford Martin School